

Notrump and Stayman

Reference: FIGB Fiori 2022, pages 28–30. 1NT: 15–17 HCP. 2NT: 21–23 HCP. Both require a balanced hand.

Fiori uses natural suit responses. Transfers are additional agreements and must be explicitly stated in an exercise.

Stayman looks for a 4–4 major-suit fit. Ask with 2♣ over 1NT or 3♣ over 2NT. There are four responses:

Opener's shape	Over 2♣	Over 3♣
No four-card major	2♦	3♦
Four hearts, not four spades	2♥	3♥
Four spades, not four hearts	2♠	3♠
Both four-card majors	2NT	3NT

In this system, 2NT is a Stayman response over 1NT. Likewise, 3NT is a Stayman response over 2NT: both show both four-card majors.

Do not confuse roles and sequences: responder's direct 3NT over 2NT chooses a contract; opener's 3NT after 3♣ describes both four-card majors.

Example: over 2NT, ♠43 ♥K52 ♦AJ952 ♣976 has 8 HCP. The partnership has 29–31 HCP and no four-card major to explore: bid 3NT.

Agreements from other editions or advanced courses do not automatically apply to this system.